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Twitter is working on a feature that lets users share locations

Dell Inspiron Z series

Dell axes the Inspiron 12 netbook, launches the Inspiron Z series sporting 11.6-inch displays and CULV processors

Zune HD

Zune HD to start selling on September 15th in the US, starting at \$220 (approximately Rs. 10,560)

Bazaar

Razer Moray

Gimme Mo...

The Moray represents Razer's first effort at earplugs. Although it's meant for gamers there is no microphone unit though an airplane adapter is present as well as three sizes of earbuds. The soft carry case is large enough for your earphones as well as a generous sized PMP. Build quality of everything is good.

When it comes to music the Moray does reasonably well with blues and jazz – female vocals have a pleasant richness to them although male vocals seem slightly hollow. Instruments like the guitar and piano are done well although cymbals do not sound as crisp as they should. Bass can get boomy and uncontrolled

and is not impactful. Sound-staging is totally absent – all sounds seem to emanate from the left and right. Instrument congestion is noticeable and intrudes on the experience with complex tracks. That being said the mid-range is a little more pleasing than the Creative EP630.

The Moray does better when gaming. Thanks to its closed nature it allows hearing even minute sounds as we discovered in Warcraft 3, although to be honest accurate positioning isn't possible. Quake 3 is much better and the boomy bass makes rocket whooshes and railgun pings



sound scary and will have you whipping around. The shorter cord may spell trouble for a lot of gamers – pity and extension wasn't provided as this was expected.

For the price of Rs. 2,235 we must say these are overpriced, but then that's all Razer gear for you – overpriced though the legions of chanting fanboys will disagree. If you are looking for a set of gaming earphones you could just as easily go with the Creative EP630 or EP830 both of which offer comparable sound at less than half the price.

Contact

Netplace Technologies Pvt. Ltd

Phone: +91-22-42253901

Email: enquiry@

netplacetechnologies.com

Web site: www.razerzone.com

Price: Rs. 2,235

Specifications

Frequency response: 20 Hz to 11,000 KHz;

Impedance: 17 ohms;

Cord length: 1.3 metres;

Connector: 3.5mm plug

RATINGS

Features	6.5
Performance	6
Build quality	7
Value for money	5
Overall	6

Contact

Kobian Pte Ltd

Phone: +91-98100 85042

Email:

ravi_dhyani@kobian.com

Web site: www.kobian.com

Price : Rs. 1,100

Specifications

Total RMS: 28 watts (Woofer

- 4-inches, Satellites -

2.75-inches); Frequency range:

- 35 Hz ~ 18 KHz;

Controls: volume, bass

RATINGS

Features	6
Performance	3.5
Build quality	5
Value for money	7.5
Overall	5.5

Mercury iXa 240

Sound in style? Not really...

The usual 2.1 speakers are common enough and there is nothing that stands out about these. A neat looking set of stereo speakers with a dedicated woofer. The satellites are very light and constructed of plastic. The driver units are exposed, we're normally used to seeing some sort of mesh shroud. The woofer unit is small and light and doesn't feel that sturdy. The woofer is down firing therefore Mercury provided this unit with one and a half inch long rubber feet to allow for some distance between the units' driver and the floor. Incidentally the woofer driver is a mere four inches – not impressive, we figured even for an entry level setup at least a 5.25-inch woofer should have been provided. The satellites have a single 2.75-inch driver each – no horns or tweeters here. Connectivity is provided

via RCA ports on the woofer.

We hooked these up to our test system and turned the volume up to around 75 percent. It's safe to say these speakers weren't meant for high volumes and the distortion that occurred was enough to deter us from venturing higher. Once the volume has been set to 40 percent the sound doesn't distort. Mind you, they're still reasonably loud for a desktop set of speakers, but those who like their music loud or people who want to watch movies from a bit of a distance will be disappointed. The bass is seriously lacking, especially noticeable in movies and games but also with music. The mid-range is decent and vocals are clear, unfortunately the music isn't involving – vocals don't have weight to them and neither do the guitar notes. The highs are seriously rolled off

and there is a lot of muddiness to the sound when playing any music that is even distantly complex, metal and rock tracks sound congested.

So who would buy these given our list of complaints that could span a page if we tried? Well for one they're cheap (Rs. 1,100) – something nearly everyone looks for. They're also decent at lower volumes where you get a little more detail.



Photographs: Manas Parekh & Jiten Gandhi